

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12405456
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 02, 2025
Inventor(s)	Iwamoto; Shunji

Zoom lens and image pickup apparatus

Abstract

A zoom lens includes, in order from an object side to an image side, a first lens unit having positive refractive power, a second lens unit having negative refractive power, and a rear group including at least four lens units that move during zooming. Distances between adjacent lens units change during zooming. The first lens unit is fixed relative to an image plane during zooming and during focusing. The first lens unit includes at least three lenses having positive refractive powers. A predetermined condition is satisfied.

Inventors:	Iwamoto; Shunji (Tochigi, JP)
Applicant:	CANON KABUSHIKI KAISHA (Tokyo, JP)
Family ID:	89845993
Assignee:	CANON KABUSHIKI KAISHA (Tokyo, JP)
Appl. No.:	18/353139
Filed:	July 17, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240053591 A1	Feb. 15, 2024

Foreign Application Priority Data

JP	2022-128262	Aug. 10, 2022
----	-------------	---------------

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G02B15/14 (20060101); G02B15/16 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **G02B15/1461** (20190801); **G02B15/16** (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: G02B (15/146); G02B (15/1461); G02B (15/16)

USPC: 359/676; 359/683; 359/684; 359/694; 359/695

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
9217851	12/2014	Iwamoto	N/A	N/A
10078202	12/2017	Iwamoto	N/A	N/A
10416421	12/2018	Iwamoto	N/A	N/A
10663703	12/2019	Iwamoto	N/A	N/A
10754169	12/2019	Iwamoto	N/A	N/A
11131829	12/2020	Iwamoto	N/A	N/A
11181717	12/2020	Iwamoto	N/A	N/A
2014/0055659	12/2013	Iwamoto	N/A	N/A
2014/0375844	12/2013	Matsumura	359/557	G02B 15/14
2015/0130969	12/2014	Nakamura	359/683	H04N 23/69
2015/0316755	12/2014	Takemoto	359/683	G02B 15/145113
2015/0362711	12/2014	Wakazono	348/360	H04N 23/72
2017/0108677	12/2016	Shimomura	N/A	G02B 15/20
2017/0336601	12/2016	Wei	N/A	G02B 13/009
2020/0271906	12/2019	Kimura	N/A	G02B 15/20
2021/0199939	12/2020	Tabata	N/A	G02B 15/145113
2021/0396977	12/2020	Tanaka	N/A	G02B 15/1461
2022/0043243	12/2021	Iwamoto	N/A	N/A
2022/0236543	12/2021	Ikeda	N/A	G02B 15/145127
2023/0010047	12/2022	Iwamoto	N/A	N/A
2023/0266583	12/2022	Iwamoto	N/A	N/A
2023/0384570	12/2022	Iwamoto	N/A	N/A

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
2019211621	12/2018	JP	G02B 13/009
2020134807	12/2019	JP	G02B 15/1461
2021036275	12/2020	JP	N/A

Primary Examiner: Won; Bumsuk

Assistant Examiner: Rickel; Alex Park

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Carter, DeLuca & Farrell LLP

Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

Technical Field

(1) One of the aspects of the embodiments relates to a zoom lens and an image pickup apparatus.

Description of Related Art

(2) A zoom lens in an image pickup apparatus is demanded to have a compact size, reduced weight, and high optical performance that satisfactorily corrects various aberrations such as chromatic aberration. The zoom lens is also demanded to have a short focal length at a wide-angle end, a large magnification variation ratio, a small F-number, and a large aperture ratio, and to be easily manufactured. The zoom lens is also demanded to have high-speed zoom operation. Japanese Patent Laid-Open No. 2020-134807 discloses a zoom lens that includes, in order from an object side to an image side, a lens unit having positive refractive power, a lens unit having negative refractive power, and a rear group having a plurality of lens units.

(3) The zoom lens disclosed in Japanese Patent Laid-Open No. 2020-134807 has difficulty in realizing high image quality and high-speed zoom operation while having a compact size, a high magnification variation ratio, and a large aperture ratio.

SUMMARY

(4) A zoom lens according to one aspect of the disclosure includes, in order from an object side to an image side, a first lens unit having positive refractive power, a second lens unit having negative refractive power, and a rear group including at least four lens units that move during zooming. Distances between adjacent lens units change during zooming. The first lens unit is fixed relative to an image plane during zooming and during focusing. The first lens unit includes at least three lenses having positive refractive powers. The following inequalities are satisfied:

$$7.50 < Lw/fw < 15.00$$

$0.20 < T2/|f2| < 0.85$ where Lw is a distance on an optical axis from a surface vertex position of a surface closest to an object in the zoom lens at a wide-angle end to the image plane, fw is a focal length of the zoom lens at the wide-angle end, $T2$ is a distance on the optical axis from a surface vertex position of a surface closest to the object of the second lens unit to a surface vertex position of a surface closest to the image plane of the second lens unit, and $f2$ is a focal length of the second lens unit. An image pickup apparatus having the above zoom lens also constitutes another aspect of the disclosure.

(5) Further features of the disclosure will become apparent from the following description of embodiments with reference to the attached drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a sectional view of a zoom lens according to Example 1.
- (2) FIGS. 2A and 2B are aberration diagrams of the zoom lens according to Example 1.
- (3) FIG. 3 is a sectional view of a zoom lens according to Example 2.
- (4) FIGS. 4A and 4B are aberration diagrams of the zoom lens according to Example 2.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a sectional view of a zoom lens according to Example 3.
- (6) FIGS. 6A and 6B are aberration diagrams of the zoom lens according to Example 3.
- (7) FIG. 7 is a sectional view of a zoom lens according to Example 4.
- (8) FIGS. 8A and 8B are aberration diagrams of the zoom lens according to Example 4.
- (9) FIG. 9 is a sectional view of a zoom lens according to Example 5.
- (10) FIGS. 10A and 10B are aberration diagrams of the zoom lens according to Example 5.
- (11) FIG. 11 is a schematic diagram of an image pickup apparatus having a zoom lens according to any one of examples.

DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

(12) Referring now to the accompanying drawings, a detailed description will be given of embodiments according to the disclosure.

(13) In order to achieve high-speed zooming, the mass and moving amount of the lens unit that moves during magnification variation (during zooming) may be reduced. In order to suppress the mass of the moving lens unit, the number of lenses in the moving lens unit may be reduced. However, the reduced number of lenses in the moving lens unit would have difficulty in correcting aberrations, and in achieving high image quality. A reduced moving amount of the moving lens unit has difficulty in achieving high magnification variation. In a case where the refractive power of the lens units in the zoom lens is increased in order to reduce the moving amount of the moving lens units, it becomes difficult to correct aberrations and to improve image quality. Therefore, in order to obtain a zoom lens that has a compact size, a high magnification variation ratio, and a large aperture ratio, and achieves high image quality and high-speed zoom operation, it is important to properly set the arrangement of the lenses and lens units in the zoom lens.

(14) The zoom lens according to each example includes a plurality of lens units. The lens units consist of, in order from the object side to the image side, a first lens unit L1 having positive refractive power, a second lens unit L2 having negative refractive power, and a rear group LR that includes at least four lens units configured to move during zooming. Distances between adjacent lens units (air spacings in the direction along the optical axis OA) change during zooming. The first lens unit L1 does not move (or is fixed) relative to the image plane during zooming and during focusing. Since a zoom lens with a high magnification variation ratio and a large aperture ratio tends to have a large front lens diameter and a large mass, fixing the first lens unit L1 relative to the image plane can easily realize high-speed zoom operations. In a case where the plurality of lens units are moved while the distances change between them, various aberrations during zooming, in particular zoom fluctuations of lateral chromatic aberration and astigmatism, can be well corrected.

(15) The following inequalities (1) and (2) are satisfied in the zoom lens according to each example:

$$7.50 < L_w / f_w < 15.00 \quad (1)$$

$$0.20 < T_2 / |f_2| < 0.85 \quad (2)$$

(16) Here, L_w is a distance on the optical axis from a surface vertex position of a surface closest to the object of the zoom lens at the wide-angle end to the image plane. f_w is a focal length of the zoom lens (entire system) at the wide-angle end. T_2 is a distance on the optical axis from a surface vertex position of a surface closest to the object to a surface vertex position of a surface closest in the second lens unit L2 to the image plane. f_2 is a focal length of the second lens unit L2.

Inequality (1) defines a relationship between the distance on the optical axis from the surface vertex position of the surface closest to the object of the zoom lens at the wide-angle end to the image plane and the focal length of the zoom lens (entire system) at the wide-angle end. In a case where the value L_w / f_w becomes higher than the upper limit of inequality (1), the lens diameter and mass of the second lens unit L2 increase and it becomes difficult to achieve high-speed zoom operations. On the other hand, in a case where the value L_w / f_w becomes lower than the lower limit of inequality (1), the refracting power of each lens unit becomes too strong, and it becomes difficult to correct various aberrations, particularly spherical aberration and astigmatism. Inequality (2) defines a relationship between the thickness on the optical axis of the second lens unit L2 and the focal length of the second lens unit L2. In a case where the thickness of the second lens unit L2 becomes too large and the value $T_2 / |f_2|$ becomes higher than the upper limit of the inequality (2), the mass of the second lens unit L2 increases, and it becomes difficult to achieve the high-speed zoom operation. On the other hand, in a case where the thickness of the second lens unit L2 becomes too small and the value $T_2 / |f_2|$ becomes lower than the lower limit of the inequality (2), it becomes difficult to suppress the aberrations generated in the second lens unit L2, and to correct various corrections, in particular zoom fluctuations of spherical aberration and astigmatism.

(17) In each example, inequalities (1) and (2) may be replaced with the following inequalities (1a)

and (2a), respectively.

$$8.02 < Lw/fw < 12.16 \quad (1a)$$

$$0.38 < T2/f2 < 0.84 \quad (2a)$$

(18) In each example, inequalities (1) and (2) may be replaced with the following inequalities (1b) and (2b), respectively.

$$8.28 < Lw/fw < 10.74 \quad (1b)$$

$$0.47 < T2/f2 < 0.83 \quad (2b)$$

(19) A description will now be given of configurations which the zoom lens according to each example may satisfy.

(20) In each example, the first lens unit L1 may have a lens (first lens) L11 disposed closest to the object and having negative refractive power. Thereby, it becomes easier to suppress the front lens diameter and to facilitate miniaturization. In each example, the rear group LR includes, in order from the object side to the image side, a third lens unit L3 having positive refractive power and a fourth lens unit L4 having positive refractive power. Changing a distance between lens units having positive refractive powers can suppress zoom fluctuations of astigmatism and easily improve optical image quality. Disposing a plurality of lens units having positive refractive powers can reduce the light height of light rays incident on the lens unit disposed closer to the image plane than the fourth lens unit L4 and easily reduce the diameter and size of the lens unit disposed closer to the image plane than the fourth lens unit L4.

(21) In each example, the lens or lens unit disposed closer to the image plane than the fourth lens unit L4 may move during focusing from infinity to a short distance. In a case where a lens unit with a large diameter disposed on the object side is fixed during focusing, and a lens or lens unit with a small diameter disposed on the image side of the fourth lens unit L4 is moved during focusing, the weight of the focus lens unit can be easily reduced, and the driving mechanism can be simplified. Thereby, the miniaturization becomes easy.

(22) In each example, the first lens unit L1 may have at least three lenses having positive refractive powers. Thereby, it becomes easy to achieve both high magnification variation and high performance.

(23) In each example, the second lens unit L2 may include, in order from the object side to the image side, a lens having negative refractive power (second lens disposed closest to the object and having negative refractive power), a lens having negative refractive power, a lens having negative refractive power, and a lens having positive refractive power. Disposing the negative lens on the object side in the second lens unit L2 can easily achieve a wide angle and suppress the diameter of the front lens.

(24) Each example may satisfy at least one of the following inequalities (3) to (15):

$$0.20 < skw/fw < 1.50 \quad (3)$$

$$1.50 < |f1/f2| < 7.70 \quad (4)$$

$$0.60 < M2/fw < 3.20 \quad (5)$$

$$-2.00 < \beta2t < -0.30 \quad (6)$$

$$0.10 < T1/f1 < 0.70 \quad (7)$$

$$0.40 < |f11/f1| < 2.20 \quad (8)$$

$$-2.00 < (r112+r111)/(r112-r111) < -0.20 \quad (9)$$

$$0.10 < MR/ft < 0.50 \quad (10)$$

$$2.00 < f3/fw < 11.00 \quad (11)$$

$$0.70 < f4/fw < 6.70 \quad (12)$$

$$0.40 < (D34w-D34t)/fw < 1.80 \quad (13)$$

$$0.60 < |f21/f2| < 3.00 \quad (14)$$

$$-2.60 < (r212+r211)/(r212-r211) < -0.50 \quad (15)$$

(25) Here, skw is a distance (back focus) on the optical axis from a surface vertex position of a surface closest to the image plane in the zoom lens at the wide-angle end to the image plane. f1 is a

focal length of the first lens unit L1. f_2 is a focal length of the second lens unit L2. M_2 is an absolute value of a moving amount of the second lens unit L2 during zooming from the wide-angle end to the telephoto end. β_{2t} is a lateral magnification of the second lens unit L2 at the telephoto end. T_1 is a distance on the optical axis from a surface vertex position of a surface closest to the object in the first lens unit L1 to a surface vertex position of a surface closest to the image plane in the first lens unit L1. f_{11} is a focal length of the lens (first lens) L11. r_{111} is a radius of curvature of a surface on the object side of the lens L11. r_{112} is a radius of curvature of a surface on the image side of the lens L11. MR is a maximum absolute value of moving amounts of the lens units in the rear group LR during zooming from the wide-angle end to the telephoto end. f_t is a focal length of the zoom lens (entire system) at the telephoto end. f_3 is a focal length of the third lens unit L3. f_4 is a focal length of the fourth lens unit L4. D_{34w} is a distance on the optical axis from a surface vertex position of a surface closest to the image plane in the third lens unit L3 to a surface vertex position of a surface closest to the object in the fourth lens unit L4 at the wide-angle end. D_{34t} is a distance on the optical axis from the surface vertex position of the surface closest to the image plane in the third lens unit L3 to the surface vertex position of the surface closest to the object in the fourth lens unit L4 at the telephoto end. f_{21} is a focal length of the lens (second lens) L21. r_{211} is a radius of curvature of a surface on the object side of the lens L21. r_{212} is a radius of curvature of a surface on the image side of the lens L21. Inequality (3) defines a relationship between the back focus at the wide-angle end and the focal length of the zoom lens (entire system). In a case where the back focus becomes too long and the value skw/fw becomes higher than the upper limit of inequality (3), the diameter of the front lens increases, and the zoom lens becomes large. On the other hand, in a case where the back focus becomes too short and the value skw/fw becomes lower than the lower limit of the inequality (3), the lens diameters of the lenses in the rear group LR becomes large, the mass of the lenses in the rear group LR becomes large, high-speed zoom operation becomes difficult. Inequality (4) defines a relationship between the focal length of the first lens unit L1 and the focal length of the second lens unit L2. In a case where the focal length of the first lens unit L1 becomes too long and the value $|f_1/f_2|$ becomes higher than the upper limit of the inequality (4), the zoom lens becomes larger. On the other hand, in a case where the focal length of the first lens unit L1 becomes too short and the value $|f_1/f_2|$ becomes lower than the lower limit of inequality (4), correction of various aberrations, especially spherical aberration and lateral chromatic aberration at the telephoto end, becomes difficult. Inequality (5) defines a relationship between the moving amount of the second lens unit L2 and the focal length at the wide-angle end. In a case where the moving amount of the second lens unit L2 becomes too large and the value M_2/fw becomes higher than the upper limit of the inequality (5), it becomes difficult to achieve high-speed zoom operation. On the other hand, in a case where the moving amount of the second lens unit L2 becomes too small and the value M_2/fw becomes lower than the lower limit of the inequality (5), it becomes difficult to achieve high magnification variation. Inequality (6) defines the lateral magnification of the second lens unit L2 at the telephoto end. In a case where the absolute value of the lateral magnification of the second lens unit L2 at the telephoto end becomes smaller than the upper limit of inequality (6), it is difficult to achieve high magnification variation. On the other hand, in a case where the absolute value of the lateral magnification of the second lens unit L2 becomes larger beyond the lower limit of the inequality (6), the magnification variation share of the second lens unit L2 increases. Thereby, it becomes difficult to correct aberrations occurring in the second lens unit L2, and in particular it becomes difficult to suppress zoom fluctuations of spherical aberration and astigmatism. Inequality (7) defines a relationship between the thickness and the focal length of the first lens unit L1. In a case where the thickness of the first lens unit L1 becomes too long and the value T_1/f_1 becomes higher than the upper limit of the inequality (7), the diameter of the front lens increases, and the size of the zoom lens increases. On the other hand, in a case where the thickness of the first lens unit L1 becomes too short and the value T_1/f_1 becomes lower than the lower limit of the inequality (7), it becomes difficult to correct

aberrations occurring in the first lens unit **L1**, especially spherical aberration and lateral chromatic aberration at the telephoto end. Inequality (8) defines a relationship between the focal length of the lens **L11** and the focal length of the first lens unit **L1**. In a case where the absolute value of the focal length of the lens **L11** becomes too large and the value $|f_{11}/f_1|$ becomes higher than the upper limit of the inequality (8), the diameter of the front lens increases. On the other hand, in a case where the absolute value of the focal length of the lens **L11** becomes too small and the value $|f_{11}/f_1|$ becomes lower than the lower limit of the inequality (8), it becomes difficult to correct aberrations generated by the lens **L11**, and in particular, it becomes difficult to correct distortion and coma at the wide-angle end. Inequality (9) defines a relationship between the radius of curvature of the surface on the object side and the radius of curvature of the surface on the image side of the lens **L11**. In a case where the value $(r_{112}+r_{111})/(r_{112}-r_{111})$ becomes higher than the upper limit of inequality (9), it becomes difficult to correct distortion. On the other hand, in a case where the value $(r_{112}+r_{111})/(r_{112}-r_{111})$ becomes lower than the lower limit of the inequality (9), the diameter of the front lens increases. Inequality (10) defines a relationship between the maximum absolute value of moving amounts of the lenses included in the rear group **LR** and the focal length of the zoom lens (entire system) at the telephoto end. In a case where the maximum absolute value of the moving amounts of the lenses included in the rear group **LR** becomes larger and the value MR/ft becomes higher than the upper limit of inequality (10), it becomes difficult to achieve high-speed zoom operation. On the other hand, in a case where the maximum absolute value of the moving amounts of the lenses included in the rear group **LR** becomes smaller and the value MR/ft becomes lower than the lower limit of the inequality (10), it is difficult to increase the magnification variation. Inequality (11) defines a relationship between the focal length of the third lens unit **L3** and the focal length of the zoom lens (entire system) at the wide-angle end. In a case where the focal length of the third lens unit **L3** becomes too long and the value f_3/fw becomes higher than the upper limit of the inequality (11), the diameter of the lens unit disposed on the image side of the third lens unit **L3** increases, and the zoom lens becomes larger. On the other hand, in a case where the focal length of the third lens unit **L3** becomes too small and the value f_3/fw becomes lower than the lower limit of the inequality (11), it becomes difficult to correct various aberrations generated in the third lens unit **L3**, and it becomes difficult to correct various aberrations in particular spherical aberration and the longitudinal chromatic aberration at the telephoto end. Inequality (12) defines a relationship between the focal length of the fourth lens unit **L4** and the focal length of the zoom lens (entire system) at the wide-angle end. In a case where the focal length of the fourth lens unit **L4** becomes longer and the value f_4/fw becomes higher than the upper limit of the inequality (12), the diameter of the lens unit disposed on the image side of the fourth lens unit **L4** increases, and the zoom lens becomes larger. On the other hand, in a case where the focal length of the fourth lens unit **L4** becomes smaller and the value f_4/fw becomes lower than the lower limit of the inequality (12), it becomes difficult to correct various aberrations generated in the fourth lens unit **L4**, and it becomes difficult to correct various variations in particular spherical aberration and astigmatism at the telephoto end, and coma at the wide-angle end. Inequality (13) defines a relationship between a distance (air space) between the third lens unit **L3** and the fourth lens unit **L4** at the wide-angle end and the telephoto end and a focal length of the zoom lens (entire system) at the wide-angle end. In a case where the distance change becomes large and the value $(D_{34w}-D_{34t})/fw$ becomes higher than the upper limit of the inequality (13), the moving amount of the fourth lens unit **L4** becomes too large and it becomes difficult to achieve high-speed zoom operation. On the other hand, in a case where the distance change becomes too small and the value $(D_{34w}-D_{34t})/fw$ becomes lower than the lower limit of the inequality (13), the zoom fluctuation of the astigmatism becomes large, and it becomes difficult to achieve high image quality. Inequality (14) defines a relationship between the focal length of the lens **L21** and the focal length of the second lens unit **L2**. In a case where the absolute value of the focal length of the lens **L21** becomes too large and the value $|f_{21}/f_2|$ becomes higher than the upper limit of the inequality

(14), the diameter of the front lens increases, and the zoom lens becomes large. On the other hand, in a case where the absolute value of the focal length of the lens L21 becomes too small and the value $|f_{21}/f_2|$ becomes lower than the lower limit of the inequality (14), it becomes difficult to correct various aberrations, especially distortion and lateral chromatic aberration at the wide-angle end. Inequality (15) defines a relationship between the radius of curvature of the surface on the object side and the radius of curvature of the surface on the image side of lens L21. In a case where the value becomes higher than the upper limit of inequality (15), it becomes difficult to correct distortion. On the other hand, in a case where the value becomes lower than the lower limit of the inequality (15), the diameter of the front lens increases.

(26) In each example, inequalities (3) to (15) may be replaced with the following inequalities (1a) to (15a):

$$\begin{aligned} 0.33 < skw/f_w < 1.13 & (3a) \\ 2.25 < |f_1/f_2| < 5.79 & (4a) \\ 0.90 < M2/f_w < 2.41 & (5a) \\ -1.05 < \beta_{2t} < -0.60 & (6a) \\ 0.17 < T1/f_1 < 0.53 & (7a) \\ 0.60 < |f_{11}/f_1| < 1.65 & (8a) \\ -1.50 < (r_{112}+r_{111})/(r_{112}-r_{111}) < -0.21 & (9a) \\ 0.17 < MR/ft < 0.38 & (10a) \\ 2.97 < f_3/f_w < 8.26 & (11a) \\ 1.04 < f_4/f_w < 5.04 & (12a) \\ 0.58 < (D_{34w}-D_{34t})/f_w < 1.35 & (13a) \\ 0.94 < |f_{21}/f_2| < 2.24 & (14a) \\ -1.49 < (r_{212}+r_{211})/(r_{212}-r_{211}) < -0.94 & (15a) \end{aligned}$$

(27) In each example, inequalities (3) to (15) may be replaced with the following inequalities (1b) to (15b):

$$\begin{aligned} 0.40 < skw/f_w < 0.95 & (3b) \\ 2.62 < |f_1/f_2| < 4.83 & (4b) \\ 1.05 < M2/f_w < 2.01 & (5b) \\ -1.00 < \beta_{2t} < -0.68 & (6b) \\ 0.21 < T1/f_1 < 0.44 & (7b) \\ 0.70 < |f_{11}/f_1| < 1.37 & (8b) \\ -0.99 < (r_{112}+r_{111})/(r_{112}-r_{111}) < -0.22 & (9b) \\ 0.21 < MR/ft < 0.32 & (10b) \\ 3.46 < f_3/f_w < 6.89 & (11b) \\ 1.21 < f_4/f_w < 4.21 & (12b) \\ 0.67 < (D_{34w}-D_{34t})/f_w < 1.10 & (13b) \\ 1.11 < |f_{21}/f_2| < 1.86 & (14b) \\ -1.33 < (r_{212}+r_{211})/(r_{212}-r_{211}) < -0.95 & (15b) \end{aligned}$$

(28) The configuration of the zoom lens according to each example will be described in detail below.

Example 1

(29) Referring now to FIGS. 1, 2A, and 2B, a description will be given of a zoom lens L0a according to Example 1. FIG. 1 is a sectional view of the zoom lens L0a at the wide-angle end in an in-focus state at infinity. In FIG. 1, a left side is an object side (front), and a right side is an image side (rear side). An aperture stop SP determines (limits) a light beam (luminous flux) of the full aperture (maximum) F-number (Fno). During focusing from an object at infinity to an object at the closest distance (close), the focus lens unit moves as indicated by an arrow "FOCUS" in FIG. 1. In a case where the zoom lens L0a is used as an imaging optical system of a digital still camera or a digital video camera, an image plane IP corresponds to an imaging plane of an image sensor

(photoelectric conversion element) such as a charge-coupled device (CCD) sensor or a complementary metal-oxide-semiconductor (CMOS) sensor. In a case where the zoom lens L0a is used as an imaging optical system in a film-based camera, the image plane IP corresponds to the film plane. The above description is the same for other sectional views.

(30) FIG. 2A is an aberration diagram of the zoom lens L0a at the wide-angle end in the in-focus state at infinity, and FIG. 2B is an aberration diagram of the zoom lens L0a at the telephoto end in the in-focus state at infinity. In a spherical aberration diagram, Fno represents an F-number. The spherical aberration diagram illustrates spherical aberration amounts for the d-line (wavelength 587.56 nm) and g-line (wavelength 435.8 nm). In an astigmatism diagram, ΔS indicates an astigmatism amount on a sagittal image plane, and ΔM indicates an astigmatism amount on a meridional image plane. A distortion diagram illustrates a distortion amount for the d-line. A chromatic aberration diagram illustrates a chromatic aberration amount for the g-line. ω is an imaging half angle of view ($^\circ$) by paraxial calculation. The above description is similarly applied to other aberration diagrams.

(31) The zoom lens L0a according to this example includes, in order from the object side to the image side, a first lens unit L1, a second lens unit L2, and a rear group LR. The rear group LR includes, in order from the object side to the image side, a third lens unit L3 having positive refractive power, a fourth lens unit L4 having positive refractive power, a fifth lens unit L5 having negative refractive power, a sixth lens unit L6 having positive refractive power, and a seventh lens unit L7 having negative refractive power. The first lens unit L1 is fixed relative to the image plane IP during magnification variation (does not move during zooming). Each lens unit moves on a different locus (a locus indicated by an arrow in FIG. 1) while the mutual distances change during magnification variation. The third lens unit L3 has an aperture stop SP. During focusing from infinity to a short distance (close), the fifth lens unit L5 moves toward the object side, and the sixth lens unit L6 moves toward the image side.

Example 2

(32) Referring now to FIGS. 3, 4A, and 4B, a description will be given of a zoom lens L0b according to Example 2. FIG. 3 is a sectional view of the zoom lens L0b at the wide-angle end in an in-focus state at infinity. FIG. 4A is an aberration diagram of the zoom lens L0b at the wide-angle end in the in-focus state at infinity, and FIG. 4B is an aberration diagram of the zoom lens L0b at the telephoto end in the in-focus state at infinity.

(33) The zoom lens L0b according to this example includes, in order from the object side to the image side, a first lens unit L1, a second lens unit L2, and a rear group LR. The rear group LR includes, in order from the object side to the image side, a third lens unit L3 having positive refractive power, a fourth lens unit L4 having positive refractive power, a fifth lens unit L5 having negative refractive power, a sixth lens unit L6 having negative refractive power, a seventh lens unit L7 having positive refractive power, and an eighth lens unit L8 having positive refractive power. The first lens unit L1 is fixed relative to the image plane IP during magnification variation (does not move during zooming). Each lens unit moves on a different locus (locus indicated by an arrow in FIG. 3) while the mutual distances change during magnification variation. The third lens unit L3 has an aperture stop SP. During focusing from infinity to a short distance, the fifth lens unit L5 moves toward the object side, and the sixth lens unit L6 moves toward the image side.

Example 3

(34) Referring now to FIGS. 5, 6A, and 6B, a description will be given of a zoom lens L0c according to Example 3. FIG. 5 is a sectional view of the zoom lens L0c at the wide-angle end in an in-focus state at infinity. FIG. 6A is an aberration diagram of the zoom lens L0c at the wide-angle end in the in-focus state at infinity, and FIG. 6B is an aberration diagram of the zoom lens L0c at the telephoto end in the in-focus state at infinity.

(35) The zoom lens L0c according to this example includes, in order from the object side to the image side, a first lens unit L1, a second lens unit L2, and a rear group LR. The rear group LR

includes, in order from the object side to the image side, a third lens unit L3 having positive refractive power, a fourth lens unit L4 having positive refractive power, a fifth lens unit L5 having positive refractive power, a sixth lens unit L6 having negative refractive power, and a seventh lens unit L7 having negative refractive power. The first lens unit L1 is fixed relative to the image plane IP during magnification variation (does not move during zooming). Each lens unit moves on a different locus (locus indicated by an arrow in FIG. 5) while the mutual distances change during magnification variation. The third lens unit L3 has an aperture stop SP. During focusing from infinity to a short distance, the fifth lens unit L5 moves toward the object side, and the sixth lens unit L6 moves toward the object side.

Example 4

(36) Referring now to FIGS. 7, 8A, and 8B, a description will be given of a zoom lens L0d according to Example 4. FIG. 7 is a sectional view of the zoom lens L0d at the wide-angle end in an in-focus state at infinity. FIG. 8A is an aberration diagram of the zoom lens L0d at the wide-angle end in the in-focus state at infinity, and FIG. 8B is an aberration diagram of the zoom lens L0d at the telephoto end in the in-focus state at infinity.

(37) The zoom lens L0d according to this example includes, in order from the object side to the image side, a first lens unit L1, a second lens unit L2, and a rear group LR. The rear group LR includes, in order from the object side to the image side, a third lens unit L3 having positive refractive power, a fourth lens unit L4 having positive refractive power, a fifth lens unit L5 having negative refractive power, a sixth lens unit L6 having positive refractive power, and a seventh lens unit L7 having negative refractive power. The first lens unit L1 is fixed relative to the image plane IP during magnification variation (does not move during zooming). Each lens unit moves on a different locus (locus indicated by an arrow in FIG. 7) while the mutual distances change during magnification variation. The third lens unit L3 has an aperture stop SP. During focusing from infinity to a short distance, the fifth lens unit L5 moves toward the object side, and the sixth lens unit L6 moves toward the image side.

Example 5

(38) Referring now to FIGS. 9, 10A, and 10B, a description will be given of a zoom lens L0e according to Example 5. FIG. 9 is a sectional view of the zoom lens L0e at the wide-angle end in the in-focus state at infinity. FIG. 10A is an aberration diagram of the zoom lens L0e at the wide-angle end in the in-focus state at infinity, and FIG. 10B is an aberration diagram of the zoom lens L0e at the telephoto end in the in-focus state at infinity.

(39) The zoom lens L0e according to this example includes, in order from the object side to the image side, a first lens unit L1, a second lens unit L2, and a rear group LR. The rear group LR includes, in order from the object side to the image side, a third lens unit L3 having positive refractive power, a fourth lens unit L4 having positive refractive power, a fifth lens unit L5 having negative refractive power, and a sixth lens unit L6 having positive refractive power. The first lens unit L1, the third lens unit L3, and the sixth lens unit L6 are fixed relative to the image plane IP during magnification variation (do not move during zooming). Each lens unit moves on a different locus (locus indicated by an arrow in FIG. 9) while the mutual distances change during magnification variation. The third lens unit L3 has an aperture stop SP. The fifth lens unit L5 moves toward the image side during focusing from infinity to a short distance.

(40) In the zoom lens according to each example, all surfaces having refractive powers include refractive surfaces. The zoom lens according to each example has an optical performance equal to or better than that of a zoom lens in that uses a diffractive optical element and a reflective surface, and less manufacturing difficulty.

(41) In the zoom lens according to each example, image stabilization may be performed by moving a part of the zoom lens in a direction including a component in the direction orthogonal to the optical axis OA. Moving the lens unit on the image side with a relatively small diameter as a part to be moved for image stabilization can make compact a driving actuator and the lens apparatus

including the zoom lens. For example, image stabilization may be performed by moving all or part of the third lens unit L3 in the direction including the component in the direction orthogonal to the optical axis OA.

(42) Numerical examples 1 to 5 corresponding to examples 1 to 5 will be illustrated below.

(43) In surface data in each numerical example, r represents a radius of curvature of each optical surface, and d (mm) represents an on-axis distance (distance on the optical axis) between an m-th surface and an (m+1)-th surface, where m is the surface number counted from the light incident side. nd represents a refractive index for the d-line of each optical element, and vd represents an Abbe number of the optical element. The Abbe number vd of a certain material is expressed as follows:

$$vd = (Nd - 1) / (NF - NC)$$

where Nd, NF, and NC are refractive indexes based on the d-line (587.6 nm), the F-line (486.1 nm), and the C-line (656.3 nm) in the Fraunhofer line, respectively.

(44) In each numerical example, all values of d, a focal length (mm), an F-number, and half an angle of view (°) are set in a case where the optical system according to each example is in an in-focus state on an infinite object. A back focus BF is a distance on the optical axis from the final lens surface (lens surface closest to the image plane) of the zoom lens to the paraxial image plane, and expressed in air conversion length. An overall lens length of the zoom lens is a length obtained by adding the back focus to the distance on the optical axis from the first lens surface to the final lens surface. The lens unit includes one or more lenses. WIDE, MIDDLE, and TELE mean a wide-angle end (position), an intermediate (middle) zoom position, and a telephoto end (position).

(45) In a case where the optical surface is an aspherical surface, an asterisk * is attached to the right side of the surface number. The aspherical shape is expressed as follows:

$$x = (h \cdot \sup{2/R}) / [1 + \{1 - (1 + k)$$

$$(h/R) \cdot \sup{2}\} \cdot \sup{1/2}] + A4 \times h \cdot \sup{4} + A6 \times h \cdot \sup{6} + A8 \times h \cdot \sup{8} + A10 \times h \cdot \sup{10} + A12 \times h \cdot \sup{12}$$

where X is a displacement amount from a surface vertex in the optical axis direction, h is a height from the optical axis in a direction orthogonal to the optical axis, a light traveling direction is set positive, R is a paraxial radius of curvature, K is a conic constant, A4, A6, A8, A10, and A12 are aspherical coefficients of respective orders. “e±XX” in the conic constant means “x10±XX.”

Numerical Example 1

(46) TABLE-US-00001 UNIT: mm SURFACE DATA

Surface No	r	d	nd	vd
1	-207.425	1.70		
2	1.83481	42.7	2.95	825
3	4.21	3.393	916	2.00
4	1.72047	34.7	4	105.832
5	8.46	1.59522	67.7	5
6	-203.044	0.15	6	124.562
7	5.68	1.72916	54.7	7
8	-487.042	0.15	8	78.249
9	6.74	1.72916	54.7	9
10	-444.181 (variable)	8601.520	1.20	1.80400
11	46.5	11	28.416	5.54
12	-738.337	1.00	1.49700	81.5
13	63.533	3.06	14	-115.610
14	1.00	1.49700	81.5	15
15	35.816	3.84	1.90366	31.3
16	169.674 (variable)			
17	(aperture stop) ∞	1.00	18	67.476
18	3.22	1.84666	23.8	19
19	-1153.421	0.60	20	55.893
20	1.20	2.00100		
21	29.1	21	34.548	6.77
22	1.51742	52.4	22	-82.213
23	3.04	23*	-43.690	0.05
24	1.59022	30.1	24	-46.141
25	1.20	1.72916	54.7	25
26	4358.607 (variable)	172.999	7.58	1.49700
27	81.5	27	-27.250	1.19
28	1.83400	37.2	28	231.097
29	0.15	29	48.103	7.69
30	1.48749	70.2	30	-81.882
31	0.15	31	42.435	9.37
32	1.43875	94.7	32	-82.878
33	0.15	33*	78.425	2.40
34	1.85400	40.4	34	37.200
35	9.41	1.61800	63.4	35
36	-70.814 (variable)			
37	161.341	1.20	1.77250	49.6
38	28.989 (variable)	38*	48.348	3.91
39	1.58313	59.4	39	95.150
40	(variable)	40	224.141	7.07
41	1.80810	22.8	41	-35.894
42	1.50	1.49700	81.5	42
43	361.709	7.03	43	-34.951
44	1.50	1.92286	20.9	44
45	-125.011 (variable)			
image plane ∞ ASPHERICAL DATA				
23rd Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 = 3.79285e-06 A6 = -1.22591e-10 A8 = 5.46760e-13				
33rd Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 = -7.34648e-06 A6 = -3.52185e-09 A8 = 3.20919e-13				
38th Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 = 1.44392e-06 A6 = 4.53989e-09 A8 = -1.13675e-13 A10 = -4.07591e-15				
VARIOUS DATA ZOOM RATIO 4.12 WIDE MIDDLE TELE Focal Length 24.72 50.19 101.86				
Fno 2.90 2.90 2.90 Half Angle of View 41.19 23.32 11.99 Overall Lens Length 212.40 212.40				
212.40 BF 11.98 26.45 21.74 d 9 0.80 16.04 34.02 d16 41.01 21.11 2.98 d25 19.68 9.87 0.79 d35				
2.80 1.19 1.18 d37 7.64 6.92 6.23 d39 6.39 8.72 23.36 d44 11.98 26.45 21.74 ZOOM LENS UNIT				

DATA Lens Unit Starting Surface Focal Length 1 1 83.05 2 10 -27.72 3 17 106.51 4 26 34.04 5 36
-45.93 6 38 163.53 7 40 -161.55

Numerical Example 2

(47) TABLE-US-00002 UNIT: mm SURFACE DATA Surface No r d nd vd 1 -208.117 2.00
2.00100 29.1 2 125.012 1.73 3 201.666 6.72 1.59522 67.7 4 -188.208 0.13 5 120.220 5.48
1.83481 42.7 6 -1189.696 0.15 7 69.551 5.71 1.83481 42.7 8 436.182 (variable) 9 214.024
1.20 1.90043 37.4 10 26.866 6.02 11 -282.246 1.20 1.59522 67.7 12 48.782 4.24 13 -64.715 1.20
1.49700 81.5 14 39.804 4.37 1.85025 30.1 15 -376.767 (variable) 16 (aperture stop) ∞ 1.00 17
76.845 3.20 1.84666 23.8 18 -332.575 0.50 19 56.009 0.90 2.00100 29.1 20 34.921 6.63 1.51742
52.4 21 -82.324 3.17 22* -40.899 0.05 1.59022 30.1 23 -43.512 1.20 1.72916 54.7 24 -438.046
(variable) 25 107.656 9.03 1.49700 81.5 26 -23.891 1.19 1.95375 32.3 27 -1561.807 0.15 28
57.153 9.76 1.43875 94.7 29 -41.965 0.15 30* 84.677 7.95 1.80400 46.5 31* -52.890 (variable)
32 185.555 2.58 1.89286 20.4 33 -333.256 1.20 1.61800 63.4 34 46.156 (variable) 35 77.039 1.20
2.00100 29.1 36 30.744 (variable) 37* 37.408 4.07 1.58313 59.4 38* 53.618 0.13 39 47.870 1.39
2.00069 25.5 40 25.731 9.31 1.61800 63.4 41 176.934 (variable) 42 54.577 7.41 1.84666 23.8 43
-80.249 1.50 1.48749 70.2 44 42.160 7.49 45 -49.214 1.50 1.92286 20.9 46 -97.002 (variable)
image plane ∞ ASPHERIC DATA 22nd Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 = 4.39269e-06 A6 =
1.10097e-09 A8 = 6.31456e-13 30th Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 = -5.80494e-06 A6 =
-2.08319e-09 A8 = -2.99833e-12 31st Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 = 1.13763e-06 A6 =
-3.28114e-09 37th Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 = 2.38842e-06 A6 = -2.70374e-09 A8 =
-1.84658e-11 A10 = 2.89507e-14 38th Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 = 6.75134e-08 A6 =
-3.59874e-09 A8 = -2.39776e-11 A10 = 3.36099e-14 VARIOUS DATA ZOOM RATIO 4.13
WIDE MIDDLE TELE Focal Length 24.73 50.23 102.12 Fno 2.90 2.90 2.90 Half Angle of View
41.19 23.30 11.96 Overall Lens Length 211.51 211.51 211.51 BF 11.80 26.61 26.29 d 8 0.80 15.28
30.36 d15 39.32 19.23 2.99 d24 19.57 9.93 0.78 d31 4.00 1.22 2.88 d34 4.47 7.50 6.25 d36 7.75
7.49 7.08 d41 1.00 1.44 12.05 d46 11.80 26.61 26.29 ZOOM LENS UNIT DATA Lens Unit
Starting Surface Focal Length 1 1 79.54 2 9 -24.54 3 16 97.60 4 25 34.35 5 32 -131.33 6 35
-51.78 7 37 123.01 8 42 770.84

Numerical Example 3

(48) TABLE-US-00003 UNIT: mm SURFACE DATA Surface No r d nd vd 1 -181.919 1.70
1.90043 37.4 2 111.072 3.71 3 364.499 5.59 1.59522 67.7 4 -177.536 0.14 5 154.743 4.78
1.75500 52.3 6 -870.763 0.15 7 84.502 7.28 1.75500 52.3 8 -367.735 (variable) 9 -2513.905
1.30 1.72916 54.7 10 27.941 6.20 11 -452.183 1.20 1.59522 67.7 12 68.302 2.86 13 -147.630 1.20
1.49700 81.5 14 37.027 4.02 1.90043 37.4 15 197.666 (variable) 16 (aperture stop) ∞ 1.00 17
70.360 3.19 1.84666 23.8 18 -1084.899 0.60 19 62.970 1.20 2.05090 26.9 20 36.953 6.53 1.56732
42.8 21 -87.660 3.17 22* -43.587 0.05 1.59022 30.1 23 -46.864 1.40 1.77250 49.6 24 3434.700
(variable) 25 68.421 7.75 1.49700 81.5 26 -34.337 1.19 1.83400 37.2 27 94.819 0.15 28 45.071
5.49 1.49700 81.5 29 1775.190 0.15 30 38.956 9.94 1.49700 81.5 31 -94.914 2.39 32* 78.620 2.50
1.85400 40.4 33* 49.978 (variable) 34* 37.006 8.81 1.58313 59.4 35* -88.576 (variable) 36
123.459 1.20 2.00100 29.1 37 40.182 (variable) 38 73.297 8.72 1.84666 23.8 39 -41.340 1.40
1.60311 60.6 40 49.128 8.20 41 -33.125 1.40 1.92286 20.9 42 -59.144 (variable) image plane ∞
ASPHERIC DATA 22nd Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 = 3.89058e-06 A6 = 6.70856e-10 A8 =
-1.58188e-12 32nd Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 = 4.26123e-06 A6 = -9.76054e-09 A8 =
-4.97564e-12 33rd Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 = 1.08509e-05 A6 = -5.04108e-09 A8 =
-2.02185e-12 A10 = 5.27144e-15 34th Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 = -1.80819e-06 A6 =
-1.87700e-09 A8 = 3.87938e-13 35th Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 = 4.45032e-06 A6 =
-4.27576e-09 A8 = 3.65399e-12 VARIOUS DATA ZOOM RATIO 4.12 WIDE MIDDLE TELE
Focal Length 24.72 50.22 101.96 Fno 2.90 2.90 2.90 Half Angle of View 41.19 23.31 11.98 Overall
Lens Length 211.02 211.02 211.02 BF 11.85 26.68 22.74 d 8 0.80 16.99 35.41 d15 44.29 21.72
3.00 d24 20.71 11.73 0.78 d33 4.43 7.45 8.57 d35 2.11 1.69 3.52 d37 10.27 8.21 20.44 d42 11.85

26.68 22.74 ZOOM LENS UNIT DATA Lens Unit Starting Surface Focal Length 1 1 94.31 2 9
-29.02 3 16 127.17 4 25 83.32 5 34 45.95 6 36 -59.94 7 38 -203.31

Numerical Example 4

(49) TABLE-US-00004 UNIT: mm SURFACE DATA Surface No r d nd vd 1 -266.746 1.60
1.90043 37.4 2 98.340 2.81 3 192.058 6.58 1.53775 74.7 4 -241.263 0.15 5 119.575 5.31
1.72916 54.7 6 -1682.093 0.15 7 76.157 6.72 1.72916 54.7 8 -880.300 (variable) 9 915.083
1.20 1.88300 40.8 10 29.841 5.73 11 -218.330 1.00 1.59522 67.7 12 63.389 3.69 13 -74.215 1.10
1.49700 81.5 14 41.057 4.98 1.77047 29.7 15 -204.631 (variable) 16 (aperture stop) ∞ 1.00 17
78.578 3.15 1.84666 23.8 18 -594.031 0.60 19 59.615 1.20 2.00100 29.1 20 36.734 7.47 1.51742
52.4 21 -83.322 3.11 22* -44.261 0.05 1.59022 30.1 23 -47.091 1.20 1.77250 49.6 24 -640.625
(variable) 25 255.634 8.10 1.49700 81.5 26 -27.474 1.30 1.90043 37.4 27 -222.061 0.15 28
41.537 8.18 1.49700 81.5 29 -105.932 2.30 30 63.231 6.49 1.49700 81.5 31 -97.379 0.15 32*
85.354 2.40 1.85400 40.4 33 34.925 8.89 1.60311 60.6 34 -78.017 (variable) 35 157.315 1.20
1.72916 54.7 36 28.256 (variable) 37* 47.159 4.54 1.58313 59.4 38 160.935 (variable) 39 210.344
5.69 1.80518 25.4 40 -46.896 1.50 1.48749 70.2 41 59.110 9.57 42 -33.883 1.20 2.00069 25.5 43
-66.006 (variable) image plane ∞ ASPHERIC DATA 22nd Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 =
3.72124e-06 A6 = 3.39835e-10 A8 = 6.96887e-13 32nd Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 =
-7.10364e-06 A6 = -3.27713e-09 A8 = -1.38031e-12 37th Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 =
1.68172e-06 A6 = 3.21879e-09 A8 = 5.86323e-12 A10 = -1.26470e-14 VARIOUS DATA
ZOOM RATIO 4.12 WIDE MIDDLE TELE Focal Length 24.78 50.31 102.06 Fno 2.90 2.90 2.90
Half Angle of View 41.12 23.27 11.97 Overall Lens Length 211.98 211.98 211.98 BF 11.63 25.76
19.01 d 8 0.80 16.58 34.70 d15 42.76 21.90 2.98 d24 19.63 10.61 0.79 d34 2.50 1.78 1.10 d36 8.07
7.90 7.19 d38 6.12 7.00 25.75 d43 11.63 25.76 19.01 ZOOM LENS UNIT DATA Lens Unit
Starting Surface Focal Length 1 1 90.57 2 9 -27.00 3 16 119.23 4 25 35.02 5 35 -47.42 6 37
112.74 7 39 -90.78

Numerical Example 5

(50) TABLE-US-00005 UNIT: mm SURFACE DATA Surface No r d nd vd 1 -8741.959 1.40
2.00100 29.1 2 77.425 2.07 3 132.828 5.55 1.48749 70.2 4 -278.544 0.15 5 81.695 4.36
1.72916 54.7 6 698.842 0.15 7 52.270 5.59 1.72916 54.7 8 496.392 (variable) 9 231.928 0.90
1.80400 46.6 10 19.761 4.24 11 -78.088 0.80 1.59282 68.6 12 53.314 3.20 13 -27.410 0.80
1.49700 81.5 14 57.444 2.55 15 69.921 2.53 1.85025 30.1 16 -72.259 (variable) 17 (aperture stop)
 ∞ 1.00 18 104.572 2.48 1.84666 23.8 19 -84.594 0.60 20 55.992 1.00 1.90043 37.4 21 31.491 4.61
1.49700 81.5 22 -70.253 3.02 23* -28.727 0.05 1.59022 30.1 24 -29.778 0.80 1.80518 25.4 25
-100.170 (variable) 26 18.384 6.47 1.49700 81.5 27 -138.084 2.89 28* 35.239 2.00 1.85400 40.4
29 12.971 8.26 1.53775 74.7 30 -46.153 (variable) 31 168.469 0.80 1.69680 55.5 32 16.983 3.73
33* 31.760 0.05 1.59022 30.1 34 29.014 3.06 1.59551 39.2 35 123.379 (variable) 36 -344.548
7.53 1.90366 31.3 37 -18.233 1.20 1.84666 23.8 38 -96.734 (variable) image plane ∞ ASPHERIC
DATA 23rd Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 = 8.09779e-06 A6 = -1.18636e-08 A8 = 6.70206e-11
28th Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 = -2.83986e-05 A6 = -4.36898e-08 A8 = -1.47706e-10 33rd
Surface K = 0.00000e+00 A4 = 7.39408e-06 A6 = 5.64098e-08 A8 = 1.50619e-10 A10 =
-4.36865e-13 VARIOUS DATA ZOOM RATIO 3.77 WIDE MIDDLE TELE Focal Length 15.45
30.00 58.20 Fno 2.90 2.90 2.90 Half Angle of View 41.48 24.48 13.21 Overall Lens Length 143.99
143.99 143.99 BF 11.90 11.90 11.90 d 8 0.80 12.86 25.80 d16 27.48 15.42 2.48 d25 14.75 4.45
0.78 d30 2.62 1.54 5.64 d35 2.60 13.97 13.54 d38 11.90 11.90 11.90 ZOOM LENS UNIT DATA
Lens Unit Starting Surface Focal Length 1 1 70.23 2 9 -18.13 3 17 85.18 4 26 26.26 5 31 -47.32 6
36 106.66

(51) TABLE 1 below summarizes values corresponding to inequalities (1) to (15) of each example (EX):

(52) TABLE-US-00006 TABLE 1 EX 1 EX 2 EX 3 EX 4 EX 5 Lw/fw 8.590 8.554 8.536 8.553
9.318 T2/f2 0.564 0.743 0.578 0.656 0.829 skw/fw 0.485 0.477 0.479 0.469 0.770 |f1/f2| 2.996

3.241 3.249 3.355 3.874 M2/fw 1.344 1.195 1.400 1.368 1.618 β_{2t} -0.990 -0.996 -0.852 -0.853
-0.691 T1/f1 0.350 0.276 0.248 0.257 0.274 |f11/f1| 0.943 0.978 0.810 0.879 1.092 (r112 + r111)/
-0.368 -0.249 -0.242 -0.461 -0.982 (r112 - r111) MR/ft 0.262 0.261 0.261 0.265 0.240 f3/fw
4.308 3.947 5.145 4.811 5.512 f4/fw 1.377 1.389 3.371 1.413 1.699 (D34w - D34t)/fw 0.764 0.760
0.806 0.760 0.904 |f21/f2| 1.279 1.395 1.305 1.295 1.485 (r212 + r211)/ -1.007 -1.287 -0.978
-1.067 -1.186 (r212 - r211)

Image Pickup Apparatus

(53) Referring now to FIG. 11, a description will be given of an image pickup apparatus (digital still camera) 10 having a zoom lens according to any one of the above examples. FIG. 11 is a schematic diagram of the image pickup apparatus 10. The image pickup apparatus 10 includes a camera body 13, a lens apparatus 11 including the zoom lens (L0a to L0e) according to any one of Examples 1 to 5, and an image sensor (light receiving element) 12 configured to photoelectrically convert an image formed by the zoom lens. The image sensor 12 is a photoelectric conversion element such as a CCD sensor or CMOS sensor. The lens apparatus 11 and the camera body 13 may be integrated with each other, or may be attachable to and detachable from each other. The image pickup apparatus 10 can realize a small size and reduced weight and high optical performance. The zoom lens according to each example is not limited to the image pickup apparatus 10 illustrated in FIG. 11, but is applicable to various image pickup apparatuses such as a broadcasting camera, a film-based camera, a surveillance cameras, and the like.

(54) Each example can provide a zoom lens and an image pickup apparatus, each of which has a compact size, a high magnification variation ratio, and a large aperture ratio, and can achieve high image quality and high-speed zoom operation.

(55) While the disclosure has been described with reference to embodiments, it is to be understood that the disclosure is not limited to the disclosed embodiments. The scope of the following claims is to be accorded the broadest interpretation so as to encompass all such modifications and equivalent structures and functions.

(56) This application claims the benefit of Japanese Patent Application No. 2022-128262, filed on Aug. 10, 2022, which is hereby incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

Claims

1. A zoom lens comprising, in order from an object side to an image side, a first lens unit having positive refractive power, a second lens unit having negative refractive power, and a rear group including at least four lens units that move during zooming, wherein distances between adjacent lens units change during zooming, wherein the first lens unit is fixed relative to an image plane during zooming and during focusing, wherein the first lens unit includes at least three lenses having positive refractive powers, and wherein the following inequalities are satisfied:

$$7.50 < L_w/f_w < 15.00$$

$$0.20 < T_2/|f_2| < 0.85$$

$$0.20 < skw/f_w < 1.13$$

$-2.00 < \beta_{2t} < -0.30$ where L_w is a distance on an optical axis from a surface vertex position of a surface closest to an object in the zoom lens at a wide-angle end to the image plane, f_w is a focal length of the zoom lens at the wide-angle end, T_2 is a distance on the optical axis from a surface vertex position of a surface closest to the object of the second lens unit to a surface vertex position of a surface closest to the image plane of the second lens unit, and f_2 is a focal length of the second lens unit, skw is a distance on the optical axis from a surface vertex position of a surface closest to the image plane of the zoom lens to the image plane at the wide-angle end, and β_{2t} is a lateral magnification of the second lens unit at a telephoto end.

2. The zoom lens according to claim 1, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$$1.50 < |f_1/f_2| < 7.70$$

where f_1 is a focal length of the first lens unit, and f_2 is a focal length of the

second lens unit.

3. The zoom lens according to claim 1, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$0.60 < M2/f_w < 3.20$ where $M2$ is an absolute value of a moving amount of the second lens unit during zooming from the wide-angle end to a telephoto end.

4. The zoom lens according to claim 1, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$0.10 < T1/f_1 < 0.70$ where f_1 is a focal length of the first lens unit, and $T1$ is a distance on the optical axis from a surface vertex position of a surface closest to the object of the first lens unit to a surface vertex position of a surface closest to the image plane of the first lens unit.

5. The zoom lens according to claim 1, wherein the first lens unit includes a first lens disposed closest to the object and having negative refractive power.

6. The zoom lens according to claim 5, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$0.40 < |f_{11}/f_1| < 2.20$ where f_1 is a focal length of the first lens unit, and f_{11} is a focal length of the first lens.

7. The zoom lens according to claim 5, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$-2.00 < (r_{112} + r_{111}) / (r_{112} - r_{111}) < -0.20$ where r_{111} is a radius of curvature of a surface on the object side of the first lens, and r_{112} is a radius of curvature of a surface on the image side of the first lens.

8. The zoom lens according to claim 1, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$0.10 < MR/f_t < 0.50$ where MR is a maximum absolute value of moving amounts of the lens units included in the rear group during zooming from the wide-angle end to a telephoto end, and f_t is a focal length of the zoom lens at the telephoto end.

9. The zoom lens according to claim 1, wherein the rear group includes, in order from the object side to the image side, a third lens unit having positive refractive power, and a fourth lens unit having positive refractive power.

10. The zoom lens according to claim 9, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$2.00 < f_3/f_w < 11.00$ where f_3 is a focal length of the third lens unit.

11. The zoom lens according to claim 9, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$0.70 < f_4/f_w < 6.70$ where f_4 is a focal length of the fourth lens unit.

12. The zoom lens according to claim 9, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$0.40 < (D_{34w} - D_{34t}) / f_w < 1.80$ where D_{34w} is a distance on the optical axis from a surface vertex position of a surface closest to the image plane in the third lens unit to a surface vertex position of a surface closest to the object in the fourth lens unit at the wide-angle end, and D_{34t} is a distance on the optical axis from the surface vertex position of the surface closest to the image plane in the third lens unit to the surface vertex position of the surface closest to the object in the fourth lens unit at a telephoto end.

13. The zoom lens according to claim 9, wherein only a lens unit disposed on the image side of the fourth lens unit moves during focusing.

14. The zoom lens according to claim 1, wherein the second lens unit includes a second lens disposed closest to the object and having negative refractive power.

15. The zoom lens according to claim 14, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$0.60 < |f_{21}/f_2| < 3.00$ where f_{21} is a focal length of the second lens.

16. The zoom lens according to claim 14, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$-2.60 < (r_{212} + r_{211}) / (r_{212} - r_{211}) < -0.50$ where r_{211} is a radius of curvature of a surface on the object side of the second lens, and r_{212} is a radius of curvature of a surface on the image side of the second lens.

17. The zoom lens according to claim 1, wherein the second lens unit includes, in order from the object side to the image side, a lens having negative refractive power, a lens having negative refractive power, a lens having negative refractive power, and a lens having positive refractive power.

18. An image pickup apparatus comprising: the zoom lens according to claim 1; and an image sensor configured to receive an image formed by the zoom lens.
